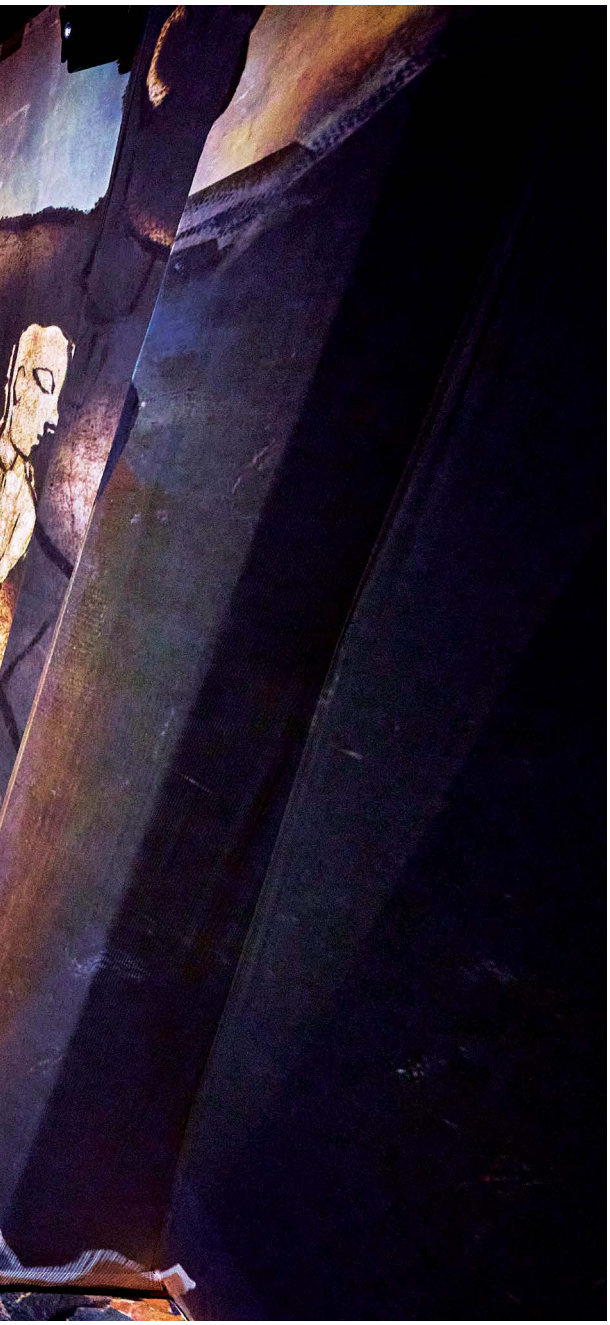


CAVE OF ART
Left, *M.F. Husain: The Rooted Nomad* immersive experience, curated by the Kiran Nadar Museum of Art; below, Husain's 'Karbala' (1990, acrylic on canvas) on its first public showing in the accompanying exhibition

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By Kai Jabir Friese in Venice

"I

DON'T THINK HUSAIN TOOK ME SERIOUSLY," SAYS KIRAN NADAR, recounting a favourite anecdote about how hard she had to pursue India's most famous artist back in the day. He did eventually produce some paintings for her new house in Delhi, in the late 1980s, but Nadar, now arguably the most prominent collector and patron of Indian modernist art, was speaking at the vernissage (or preview), last month, of a new exhibition, in the front hall of a heritage building—an old salt warehouse in Venice, the Magazzini del Sale—surrounded by a compact and priceless array of (mostly) early works by Husain. In the cavernous main hall behind the paintings is a newly commissioned 'immersive' installation, a 40-minute-long experience based on the artist's life and work, produced by Visioni, the Italian creative firm that ignited the international craze for 'immersive' art shows with a van Gogh exhibit that has toured the globe. Kiran Nadar clearly takes M.F. Husain very seriously.

Launching the exhibits later that evening at a shimmering event next door—the venue was the premises of a rowing club in this, the trendy Dorsoduro quarter of the antique city—Nadar also unveiled a new logo for the KNMA (the Kiran Nadar Museum of Art). The illuminated letters emerged quite literally from the waters of the la-

